institute frayed, both established and emerging filmmakers were forced to look for sponsors abroad. This new dependence on the market, rather than the state, brought both opportunities and challenges. Sujatha Fernandes points out, for example, that "themes of homosexuality and Afro-Cuban spirituality are seen as particularly appealing to international audiences, given the attractiveness of 'difference' as a marketable commodity."[31] This meant that previously obscured themes could now be explored. But dependence on the market could pose its own demands and limits on artistic freedom and imagination. Nevertheless, joint productions of the 1990s co-sponsored by ICAIC and foreign sources, like *Guantanamera* and *La vida es silbar* enjoyed critical acclaim both on and off the island.

Meanwhile, what Ann Marie Stock called "street filmmakers" also emerged in the Special Period. Making use of new cheaper and lighter technology like hand-held video cameras, and pursued by young aspiring filmmakers outside of ICAIC, a whole new genre of Cuban film developed out of adversity. "Out of necessity, working with limited budgets and without industry infrastructure, this generation became adept at *resolviendo* and *inventando*," Stock explains. Most of their films are short, and many are documentaries. Children of the Special Period, the new cineastes "turn their cameras toward the margins, to recover the disenfranchised, those who have been left behind by Cuba's hegemonic socialist project."[32]

Films like Humberto Padrón's *Video de familia* (2001) illustrate some of the artistic and political strengths of the genre. Shot independently, the film was distributed by ICAIC and won numerous awards in Cuba and internationally. The story takes the form of a video postcard, recorded by family members to the son (or brother) who moved to Miami four years earlier. As the camera records, the family conversation explodes in arguments about race, politics, emigration, family relations, everyday life, and the daughter's unexpected revelation of the absent son's homosexuality.

Many of the new Cuban organizations and projects operated within the spaces for civil society delineated by legal guarantees. Some have pressed the limits and sought more fundamental changes in Cuba's laws